

INTERNATIONAL MONTESSORI HOUSE SARAJEVO

KINDERGARTEN CALENDAR 2026/2027

Parent Guide – Narrative Overview

The calendar below is based on the official Kindergarten Calendar for 2026/2027, adopted by the International Montessori House Sarajevo (IMH) in accordance with the Law on Preschool Education of Sarajevo Canton, and aligned with the principles of the Montessori educational approach. The full graphic calendar is available on the kindergarten website: www.montessorihouse.ba

Academic Year Overview

Academic year: 1 September 2026 – 31 August 2027

Semester 1: 1 September 2026 – 31 January 2027

Semester 2: 1 February 2027 – 31 August 2027

Full Year Calendar – Key Dates

Colour guide: ● Kindergarten Holiday ● Public Holiday ● Non-teaching day ● Event

Period	Dates	Type	Notes
First Day of Kindergarten	Tue, 1 Sep 2026	Kindergarten	All groups begin. Welcome day for new families.
Parents Evening	Fri, 18 Sep 2026	Event	First formal parent–teacher meeting of the year.
Staff Training Day	Fri, 25 Sep 2026	Non-teaching	IMH closed for children. Staff professional development. Parents arrange alternative care.
Halloween	Sat, 31 Oct 2026	Event	Creative activity at kindergarten.
Laternenfest	Fri, 13 Nov 2026	Event	St Martin's lantern festival. Traditional Montessori celebration.
Statehood Day (BiH)	Wed, 25 Nov 2026	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed. Foundation of ZAVNOBiH, 1943.
Thanksgiving Day	Thu, 26 Nov 2026	Event	Intercultural celebration of gratitude and community.
Winter Celebration (Toddlers)	Thu, 17 Dec 2026	Event	Toddler group end-of-term celebration.
Winter Celebration (Preschool)	Fri, 18 Dec 2026	Event	Preschool group end-of-term celebration.
Catholic Christmas	Fri, 25 Dec 2026	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed.
Winter Holidays	21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	Kindergarten Holiday	Includes Catholic Christmas, Orthodox Christmas, and New Year's Day. Kindergarten closed for children and staff.
New Year's Day	Fri, 1 Jan 2027	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed.
Orthodox Christmas	Thu, 7 Jan 2027	Event	Julian calendar Christmas. Kindergarten open, regular working day.
Semester 2 Begins	Mon, 1 Feb 2027	Kindergarten	All groups resume.
Carnival	Mon, 8 Feb 2027	Event	Traditional celebration with costumes and creative activities.

Independence Day (BiH)	Mon, 1 Mar 2027	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed. 1992 independence referendum.
Women's Day	Mon, 8 Mar 2027	Event	Awareness activity. Gender equality and appreciation.
Eid al-Fitr	Tue, 9 Mar 2027	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed. End of Ramadan.
Catholic Easter	Sun, 28 Mar 2027	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed.
Spring Holidays	29 Mar – 2 Apr 2027	Kindergarten Holiday	Kindergarten closed for children and staff.
Staff Training Day	Fri, 16 Apr 2027	Non-teaching	IMH closed for children. Staff professional development. Parents arrange alternative care.
Labor Day	Sat, 1 May & Mon, 3 May 2027	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed Mon, 3 May.
Orthodox Easter	Sun, 2 May 2027	Public Holiday	Combined with Labour Day weekend.
Mother's Day	Sun, 9 May 2027	Event	Classroom gratitude activity.
Eid al-Adha	Sun, 16 & Mon, 17 May 2027	Public Holiday	Kindergarten closed Mon, 17 May. Feast of Sacrifice.
Summerfest	Fri, 18 Jun 2027	Event	End-of-year celebration. Children's awards and performances.
Summer Holidays	12 Jul – 31 Jul 2027	Kindergarten Holiday	Kindergarten closed for children and staff.
Last Day of Kindergarten	Tue, 31 Aug 2027	Kindergarten	All groups. Last operational day for children.

Kindergarten Holidays – Summary

Holiday	Dates	Note
Winter Holidays	21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	Includes Catholic Christmas, Orthodox Christmas, and New Year's Day. Kindergarten closed for both children and staff.
Spring Holidays	29 Mar – 2 Apr 2027	Kindergarten closed for both children and staff.
Summer Holidays	12 Jul – 31 Jul 2027	Kindergarten closed for both children and staff.

IMPORTANT – IMH does not observe Autumn Holidays:

The International Montessori House does **not** close for an autumn break. The kindergarten operates normally during the period 19–23 October 2026. Only Winter, Spring, and Summer Holidays apply to IMH.

All three holiday periods (Winter, Spring, Summer) are full closures for both children and staff.

Public Holidays – Kindergarten Closed

IMH observes the following official public holidays, reflecting the multicultural character of the kindergarten and BiH law. On these days the kindergarten is closed for both children and staff.

Holiday	Date	Context
Statehood Day (BiH)	Wed, 25 Nov 2026	Foundation of ZAVNOBiH, 1943
Catholic Christmas	Fri, 25 Dec 2026	Christian holiday
New Year's Day	Fri, 1 Jan 2027	Civic and cultural holiday
Independence Day (BiH)	Mon, 1 Mar 2027	1992 independence referendum
Eid al-Fitr	Tue, 9 Mar 2027	End of Ramadan
Catholic Easter	Sun, 28 Mar 2027	Christian holiday
Labor Day	Mon, 3 May 2027	International Labour Day
Orthodox Easter	Sun, 2 May 2027	Combined with Labour Day weekend
Eid al-Adha	Mon, 17 May 2027	Feast of Sacrifice

Kindergarten Events

The following kindergarten events are scheduled throughout the year. They contribute to children's holistic, cultural, social, and emotional development within the Montessori framework. Details and preparation notes are communicated by email in advance of each event.

Event	Date	Description
Parents Evening	Fri, 18 Sep 2026	First formal parent–teacher meeting of the academic year.
Halloween	Sat, 31 Oct 2026	Creative expression activity; Anglo-Saxon tradition.
Laternenfest	Fri, 13 Nov 2026	St Martin's lantern festival; traditional community celebration.
Thanksgiving Day	Thu, 26 Nov 2026	Intercultural celebration of gratitude and community.
Winter Celebration (Toddlers)	Thu, 17 Dec 2026	End-of-term celebration for the Toddler group.
Winter Celebration (Preschool)	Fri, 18 Dec 2026	End-of-term celebration for the Preschool group.
Carnival	Mon, 8 Feb 2027	Traditional celebration with costumes and creative activities.

Women's Day	Mon, 8 Mar 2027	Gender equality awareness activity.
Mother's Day	Sun, 9 May 2027	Classroom gratitude activity.
Summerfest	Fri, 18 Jun 2027	End-of-year celebration; children's awards and performances.

Staff Training Days – IMH Closed

On Staff Training Days, the International Montessori House is closed for all children. These days are dedicated to staff professional development. Parents are required to arrange alternative care for their children.

Date	Day	Note
Fri, 25 Sep 2026	Staff Training Day 1	IMH closed. Written notice given ≥14 days in advance.
Fri, 16 Apr 2027	Staff Training Day 2	IMH closed. Written notice given ≥14 days in advance.

Parents are notified of Staff Training closures at least 14 days in advance.

Important Operational Notes

The IDSS Preschool Group operates within the Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo but follows the calendar of the International Montessori House (IMH). This means certain closures and open days differ from those of IDSS Grades 1–9. The following dates require special attention from parents:

Period	Note for Parents
19–23 Oct 2026	Autumn Holidays for IDSS Grades 1–9. IMH REMAINS OPEN; the kindergarten follows its own operational calendar.
Fri, 25 Sep 2026	Staff Training Day. Kindergarten closed for all children. Parents arrange alternative care. Written notice given ≥14 days in advance.
Fri, 16 Apr 2027	Staff Training Day. Kindergarten closed for all children. Parents arrange alternative care. Written notice given ≥14 days in advance.
29 Mar – 2 Apr 2027	Spring Holidays. Kindergarten closed for children and staff.
12 Jul – 31 Jul 2027	Summer Holidays. Kindergarten closed for children and staff. The kindergarten reopens in August; last operational day for children is Tue, 31 Aug 2027.

Calendar Amendments

The management of the International Montessori House reserves the right to amend individual dates in response to exceptional circumstances, with prior written notice to parents and staff. All amendments are published promptly on www.montessorihouse.ba. In case of kindergarten closure due to severe weather, IMH follows the guidance of public preschools in Sarajevo Canton and notifies families by email.

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